

W E D N E S D A Y

PATIENCE:

A FRUIT OF LOVE

“But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law.”

Galatians 5:22, 23

Let's learn about fruit from around the World:

FIGS

Figs have a purple-colored outer skin and fade pink-to-white color flesh that makes it very appealing to the eye. It is shaped like a pear or a crushed teardrop, but its taste is nothing to cry about. On the contrary, the flesh is glossy and juicy, and they have a sweet, nutty taste and a chewy texture that makes it such a delight!

If you want to find an abundance of the most delicious figs, travel to Turkey, Egypt, Greece, or Morocco. Fresh as well as dried figs contain lots of good b-complex vitamins. They can be used for medicine and dessert.

TODAY'S SPIRITUAL FRUIT IS

PATIENCE

Paul writes in Galatians 5:22 and 23: “But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, **patience**, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law.”

Dictionary.com defines patience as: “the quality of being patient, as the bearing of provocation, annoyance, misfortune, or pain, without complaint, loss of temper, irritation, or the like.” Also, “an ability or willingness to suppress restlessness or annoyance when confronted with delay.”

Wow! It would really be something if each one of us could live our lives within the boundaries of these definitions about patience. Think about it. The relationship between a husband and his wife, or a wife and her husband would be completely transformed if instead of complaining, losing their temper or being irritated about everything they could just be calm. Well, for one, there would be greater peace in our homes. Our children would have the joy and blessing of growing up in an environment without tension and anxiety. Wouldn't that be something?

Imagine, that instead of parents yelling and screaming at their children because they are a little late on Sabbath morning, they would simply allow the sweet Spirit of God to give them the patience to respond calmly and with composure rather than being agitated or frantic and destroying the main reason for Sabbath? We know it is important to get to church on time, but even being on time could not be more important than exhibiting the Spirit of Jesus in our homes.

Yes, this fruit of love called patience is something to really pray for during *Family Togetherness Week of Prayer*. While some may think developing this kind of patience is impossible—based on their current family situations—we hasten to remind you what Jesus has to say

about this kind of thinking: “With people it is impossible, but not with God;” Jesus says. “for all things are possible with God” (Mk 10:27).

The truth is, when we admit that we don't have the capacity or power to respond with patience in difficult family situations, it is when God can perform the impossible on our behalf. We only need to call on Jesus, and He will fill us with His Spirit and produce the sweet fruit of patience in our lives. Then our family relationships and all other relationships will have the capacity to be transformed by the presence of the Spirit of God dwelling in our lives every day.

Ellen White's counsel on patience is: “If impatient words are spoken to you, never reply in the same spirit” (*Gospel Workers*, p. 475). We are also reminded by the wise counsel of Scripture: “A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger” (Prov 15:1).

We pray you will allow the Spirit of God to help you develop greater patience in your response to the members of your family and to others. That regardless of how difficult the circumstances might be you will choose to “walk by the Spirit” (v. 16) instead of indulging “the deeds of the flesh,” (v. 19). This will ensure that your family interactions, and your relationship with everyone else, will be filled with God's love and bring greater blessings to your home and to the church every day. So, Pick the fruit of patience today.

PRAY:

Dear Heavenly Father, we ask You to grant us patience today. Help us to practice patience in our homes each day. And may we remember to be patient with everyone we meet today. In Jesus' name, amen.



FRUITFUL **PATIENCE** ACTIVITY

The Toothpick Challenges!

- **Toothpick stack:** Stand the bottle on the table. Use a jar with a wider mouth if you have younger children. Give each person 12 toothpicks (or use dried beans or small stones if you don't have toothpicks). Take it in turns to lay a toothpick in a balanced pile on the mouth of the bottle. If any toothpicks fall off the bottle during your turn, add them to your pile. See who can place all their toothpicks safely on the bottle/jar mouth first.
- **Toothpick drop:** Stand the bottle on the table about 40 cm from the edge. Give each person 12 toothpicks. Take it in turns to sit down at the table in front of the bottle. Hold a toothpick of about 8-10 cm above the mouth of the bottle and try to drop the toothpick into the bottle. If it falls on the table, you keep the toothpick, and the turn passes to the next person. Use a jar for younger children, so that the task is easier for them to manage.

Other patience activities:

- Alternatively, do one of these activities together: make a jigsaw, build a construction kit together, plant some seeds, build a tower using only a pack of index cards, etc.



BIBLE VERSE ACTIVITY

You will need:

- Scissors, newspaper or magazine, glue, and paper.

Instructions:

- This activity requires patience!
- Work on your own, or as a family, to make a mini poster of the memory verse.
- Find large letters in the newspaper or magazine.
- Cut them out so that each letter or number is on a separate rectangle of paper.
- Arrange the letters and numbers on a sheet of paper to spell out the verse and its reference, and then stick them down with glue.
- Add other pictures from the magazine or newspaper to decorate the poster.
- Place it where it will remind everyone in your home to be more patient – maybe on the bathroom door, inside the front door or in the kitchen!

— **QUESTIONS** — TO TALK ABOUT TOGETHER

- Patience is a fruit of the Spirit because...
- Jesus showed patience with others when...
- Other Bible characters who were patient were...
- I find it hardest to be patient when...
- Some things that help me to be patient are...
- One time that I was patient this week was when...
- We can help each other to be more patient by...
- Pray: Thank You, God, for helping us to be patient this week when...